



Rise. Register. Grow.

In business, leaders often talk about a "VUCA" world — one defined by Volatility, Uncertainty, Complexity, and Ambiguity (Bennett & Lemoine, 2014). Prices shift overnight, regulations change, and the road to formalising a small food business can feel impossible to predict. That is exactly the world our traders are operating in. So in this VUCA world, we are here to help you VUKA ;-)

Journey 7: Make People Remember You

This is **Journey 07** of the VUKA curriculum: every journey a food trader needs, from checking whether you're ready to grow, right through to scaling into a bigger business, in one consistent, scenario-driven format.

Each lesson takes 3–7 minutes: a real scenario, a quick explanation, one practical tip, a quick challenge, and a badge.

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Journey 7: Make People Remember You

"Two stalls sell the same kota, at the same price, in the same street. Why does one have a queue, and the other doesn't?"

Branding is how people see and remember your food business. It's built through every item of food you sell, and every interaction you have with customers, every single day.

What Branding Actually Means (And Why Bother)

""Let me go buy amagwinya from that lady" or "let me go buy amagwinya from [your business name]": which one turns a one-time buyer into a regular?"

More than 80% of people say trust is a leading reason why they buy, which is why branding matters no matter how big or small your food business is (Cloudfusion, 2025). Good branding helps people remember you, and people don't forget a business with the same colours and packaging every time (Dandu, 2015). It also builds trust: when customers see the same neat packaging and name every time, they feel emotionally safe buying from you, and with so many other people selling food, being memorable is what makes people choose you over someone else. Branding matters for your team too. It makes employees feel proud to be part of something real and growing, not just doing a small job (Cloudfusion, 2025).

 **QUICK TIP** Branding isn't a logo you design once and forget. It's the sum of every small, repeated detail a customer experiences.

 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Write down what you want a customer to say about your business to a friend, in their own words.

Complete this and earn:  "Brand Aware" badge

Know Who You're Really Talking To

"If your branding tried to please absolutely everyone, would anyone actually remember it?"

Start by understanding who your audience is: the specific group of people your food business serves, and the problem you're solving for them. Your branding should connect with their habits, likes, dislikes, and daily life. From there, build a brand strategy, a plan for your long-term goals and how your business will meet them. Two of its core elements are brand purpose (why does your business exist, and what value does it add to your audience's life? This becomes your mission statement) and brand vision (where do you see your business in the future? This shapes your long-term goals) (Yolisa Motha, 2021).

 **QUICK TIP** If you're not sure who your audience is, look at who's already buying from you regularly, and build outward from there.

 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Answer in one sentence each: why does your business exist (purpose), and where do you see it in three years (vision)?

Complete this and earn:  "Strategy Starter" badge

Give Your Brand a Voice and a Vibe

"If your business could talk, would it crack a joke, or keep things strictly formal?"

Your brand also needs a personality, to make it more human and relatable. Think about how you want customers to see you: personable or corporate, exciting or calm, modern or rooted in tradition, playful or serious, accessible or premium. From that personality comes your brand voice, how your brand speaks and its tone, as if it were a real person talking to a customer. Finally, your brand tagline is a short, memorable line that sums all of this up in one breath (Yolisa Motha, 2021).

 **QUICK TIP** Say your tagline out loud to a friend or family member. If they can repeat it back a minute later, it's working.



 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Write a one-line tagline for your business.

Complete this and earn:  "Found My Voice" badge

Build a Look People Recognise

"Could a customer spot your packaging in a crowd of ten other food stalls, from across the taxi rank?"

Beyond strategy, you need a brand identity, the visual elements that make up your brand. Your logo is the face of your business, the symbol people recognise before they even read your name; a good logo is simple, memorable, and affordable (some of the world's biggest logos cost only a few hundred rand to design). Even shapes carry meaning: round shapes feel warm and inviting, squares and rectangles feel strong and reliable, vertical lines feel bold, horizontal lines feel calm. Your colour palette matters too, since colours trigger feelings: red creates an urge to eat, green suggests fresh and healthy ingredients. Start with one to three main colours, then build outward. Keep your typography, the fonts you use, consistent everywhere your business name appears, from your menu to your social media (Yolisa Motha, 2021).

 **QUICK TIP** Consistency beats perfection. The same colours and fonts used everywhere, even if simple, are more powerful than an elaborate design used inconsistently.

 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Pick your main one or two brand colours, and check they appear on your packaging, sign, and social media.

Complete this and earn:  "Look Locked In" badge

Sources for Fact-Checking: Legislation & Regulation

Every legal fact in Journeys 3, 4, and 10 is drawn from current South African legislation and regulator guidance:

- Regulations Governing General Hygiene Requirements for Food Premises (R638 of 2018), under the Foodstuffs, Cosmetics and Disinfectants Act 54 of 1972 — enforced by municipal Environmental Health Departments.
- Regulations Relating to the Labelling and Advertising of Foodstuffs (R146), under the Foodstuffs, Cosmetics and Disinfectants Act 54 of 1972 — Department of Health.
- Businesses Act 71 of 1991 — gov.za.
- Companies Act 71 of 2008 and Companies and Intellectual Property Commission (CIPC) — company registration, business structure conversion, and trade mark registration — cipc.co.za.
- National Regulator for Compulsory Specifications (NRCS), Food and Associated Industries division — canned, smoked, and vacuum-packed products — nrcs.org.za.
- South African Revenue Service (SARS), Small Businesses – Taxpayers, Tax Compliance Status system, and Budget 2026 Frequently Asked Questions (VAT and Turnover Tax threshold changes effective 1 April 2026) — sars.gov.za.
- Unemployment Insurance Act 63 of 2001 and Unemployment Insurance Contributions Act 4 of 2002 — Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- Compensation for Occupational Injuries and Diseases Act 130 of 1993 (COIDA) — Compensation Fund, Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- Basic Conditions of Employment Act 75 of 1997 — Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- National Environmental Management: Waste Act 59 of 2008 and Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) Regulations (Government Notice R.1184, 2020) — Department of Forestry, Fisheries and the Environment — dffe.gov.za.
- Broad-Based Black Economic Empowerment Act 53 of 2003, and the Codes of Good Practice on B-BBEE (Exempted Micro-Enterprise thresholds) — dtic.gov.za.
- Protection of Personal Information Act 4 of 2013 (POPIA) — Information Regulator South Africa — info regulator.org.za.



- Consumer Protection Act 68 of 2008 — online and distance sales provisions — gov.za.
- African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) — South African implementation guidance — dtic.gov.za.

Note: municipal fees, thresholds, and application processes vary by area and are periodically revised by government and regulators. Verify current requirements directly with the relevant municipality or regulator before publishing final figures in the app.

Sources & Further Reading: Business Practice, Marketing & Financial Literacy

Branding and digital marketing facts in Journeys 6 and 7 draw on the following:

- Cloudfusion (2025). 7 Essential Reasons Why Branding Is Important for Business. Cloudfusion.co.za.
- Dandu, R. (2015). What Is Branding and Why Is It Important for Your Business? Brandingmag.
- Mercer, S. (2026). What to Post When You Have Nothing to Post: 10 Content Ideas for Summerville Businesses. What's Up Summerville.
- Why food photography is important for your food business. candyfoxstudio.com.
- Yolisa Motha (2021). A Guide to Branding a Small Business. iKhokha.

Statistics on South African small business communication, time management, professionalism, networking, record-keeping, and banking (Journeys 1, 2, 8, and 9) are drawn from national small business research. Verify current figures against original sources before publishing final numbers in the app.

Growth-readiness, lending-risk, funding, and stock-management facts in Journeys 1, 2, 5, and 9 draw on the following:

- National Debt Advisors (2021). Stay away from unregistered money-lenders. nationaldebtadvisors.co.za.
- Startup Mag (2025). Scaling Signals: Ten Signs Your Small Business Is Ready to Grow. startupmag.co.za; Lula (2025). 5 Signs Your Business is Ready for Growth Capital. lula.co.za.
- RegInsights (2024). Small Business Funding. regenesys.net/reginsights.
- Graduates24 (n.d.). NYDA Grant Programme Small Business Funding in South Africa. graduates24.com.
- Okhantu (2025). SEDFA Funding 2026: Requirements, Amounts & How to Apply. okhantu.co.za.
- Ready Accounting (2026). Inventory management tips for cost savings and efficiency. readyaccounting.co.za.
- Xtraspace (2024). Small Business Inventory Management in SA: 10 Top Tips. xtraspace.co.za.

Sources & Further Reading: The VUCA Concept

The mission statement on the cover page draws on the following:

- Bennett, N., & Lemoine, G. J. (2014). What VUCA Really Means for You. Harvard Business Review, 92(1/2), 27.

